Vertical Privilege Escalation Incident Report

Kestrel Manufacturing Corp - erp.kestrelmfg.local

Source file: /home/steiner254/Desktop/Github Projects/AH-Scripting-Practicals/Bash_Scripting/01_Log_Analysis/scripts/../logs/03_privilege_escalation_kestrel_manufacturing.log
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Generated by: Bash Log/PCAP Analysis Toolkit (pure Bash, no external report dependencies)

CRITICAL: 107 accounts self-escalated to admin, 23 rogue admin accounts created, 20 payroll records tampered

Executive Summary

Bulk IDOR attempts against self/role API
902
Successful self-escalations
107 (11.9% of attempts)
Denied admin-area recon probes
3
Rogue admin accounts created
23
Unauthorized finance portal accesses
23
Payroll fraud anomalies
20
Audit-log deletion attempts (blocked)
1
Accounts disabled by incident response
19

Bulk Automated IDOR Sweep

A leaked internal API token dump was used to script the broken self-role-change endpoint against every employee account. Most tokens were stale and denied, but a meaningful fraction were still valid, each producing an immediate role escalation.

Total attempts	902
Succeeded	107

Accounts Successfully Escalated to Admin (sample)

```
2026-08-02 23:10:50 | user=d.wanjiru | dept=Logistics | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDAR
2026-08-02 23:12:10 | user=a.achieng | dept=Finance | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD
2026-08-02 23:13:27 | user=b.kiptoo | dept=Logistics | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD
2026-08-02 23:15:49 | user=a.hassan | dept=Warehouse | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD
2026-08-02 23:16:35 | user=c.njoroge | dept=Logistics | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDAR
2026-08-02 23:17:16 | user=a.maina | dept=Sales | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD | ne
2026-08-02 23:18:04 | user=e.akinyi | dept=Logistics | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD
2026-08-02 23:19:08 | user=c.gitau | dept=Finance | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD |
2026-08-02 23:19:18 | user=w.wambui | dept=Sales | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD | n
2026-08-02 23:19:31 | user=h.chepkoech | dept=Logistics | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STAND
```

```
2026-08-02 23:19:39 | user=r.njeri | dept=Warehouse | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD
2026-08-02 23:22:43 | user=e.otieno | dept=Sales | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD | n
2026-08-02 23:23:36 | user=i.kemboi | dept=Quality Assurance | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=
2026-08-02 23:24:16 | user=e.njeri2 | dept=Sales | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD | n
2026-08-02 23:24:44 | user=s.abdullahi | dept=Logistics | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STAND
2026-08-02 23:25:03 | user=r.karanja | dept=Procurement | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STAND
2026-08-02 23:25:27 | user=i.chepkoech | dept=Procurement | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STA
2026-08-02 23:25:36 | user=v.wafula | dept=Warehouse | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDARD
2026-08-02 23:26:10 | user=g.wanjiru | dept=Warehouse | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=STANDAR
2026-08-02 23:26:34 | user=l.chebet | dept=Quality Assurance | role=admin | action=ROLE_CHANGED | old_role=
```

Denied Reconnaissance on Admin Area (pre-escalation probing)

```
2026-08-03 01:31:16 | user=j.mwangi77 | action=ACCESS_ATTEMPT | target=/admin/users | src_ip=10.20.4.118 |
2026-08-03 01:31:28 | user=j.mwangi77 | action=ACCESS_ATTEMPT | target=/admin/roles | src_ip=10.20.4.118 |
2026-08-03 01:31:42 | user=j.mwangi77 | action=ACCESS_ATTEMPT | target=/admin/audit-log | src_ip=10.20.4.11
```

Rogue Admin Accounts Created

```
creator=a.waweru -> new_admin=svc_a.waweru_bak
creator=t.kiprotich -> new_admin=svc_t.kiprotich_bak
creator=m.kiptoo -> new_admin=svc_m.kiptoo_bak
creator=d.otieno2 -> new_admin=svc_d.otieno2_bak
creator=a.onyango -> new_admin=svc_a.onyango_bak
creator=w.akinyi -> new_admin=svc_w.akinyi_bak
creator=y.wanjiru2 -> new_admin=svc_y.wanjiru2_bak
creator=j.mwangi2 -> new_admin=svc_j.mwangi2_bak
creator=d.kimani3 -> new_admin=svc_d.kimani3_bak
creator=a.mohamed -> new_admin=svc_a.mohamed_bak
creator=s.mwangi3 -> new_admin=svc_s.mwangi3_bak
creator=s.wanjiru -> new_admin=svc_s.wanjiru_bak
creator=f.wafula2 -> new_admin=svc_f.wafula2_bak
creator=o.gitau2 -> new_admin=svc_o.gitau2_bak
creator=i.chepkoech -> new_admin=svc_i.chepkoech_bak
creator=g.wanjiru -> new_admin=svc_g.wanjiru_bak
creator=m.odhiambo2 -> new_admin=svc_m.odhiambo2_bak
creator=r.njeri3 -> new_admin=svc_r.njeri3_bak
creator=m.rotich -> new_admin=svc_m.rotich_bak
creator=h.chepkoech -> new_admin=svc_h.chepkoech_bak
creator=j.mwangi77 -> new_admin=svc_backup_admin28
creator=j.mwangi77 -> new_admin=helpdesk_temp65
creator=j.mwangi77 -> new_admin=n.chebet29
```

Unauthorized Finance Portal Access (sample)

```
2026-08-03 00:45:47 user=a.waweru target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:54:25 user=t.kiprotich target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:54:58 user=m.kiptoo target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:55:10 user=d.otieno2 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:55:40 user=a.onyango target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:58:33 user=w.akinyi target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 00:58:35 user=y.wanjiru2 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:00:44 user=j.mwangi2 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:02:43 user=d.kimani3 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:04:50 user=a.mohamed target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:05:05 user=s.mwangi3 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:05:13 user=s.wanjiru target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:09:32 user=f.wafula2 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:10:56 user=o.gitau2 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:22:49 user=i.chepkoech target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:23:10 user=g.wanjiru target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:23:27 user=m.odhiambo2 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:26:22 user=r.njeri3 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:29:01 user=m.rotich target=/finance/payroll
```

```
2026-08-03 01:30:55 user=h.chepkoech target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:36:01 user=j.mwangi77 target=/finance/payroll
2026-08-03 01:36:12 user=j.mwangi77 target=/finance/bank_accounts
2026-08-03 01:36:34 user=j.mwangi77 target=/finance/payroll/employees
```

Payroll Fraud Anomalies (sample)

```
2026-08-03 00:46:16 | user=a.waweru | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1284 | fi
2026-08-03 00:54:35 | user=t.kiprotich | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-6271 |
2026-08-03 00:55:17 | user=m.kiptoo | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-8724 | fi
2026-08-03 00:55:44 | user=d.otieno2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-3391 | f
2026-08-03 00:56:15 | user=a.onyango | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-3352 | f
2026-08-03 00:58:45 | user=w.akinyi | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-5679 | fi
2026-08-03 00:59:00 | user=y.wanjiru2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-3537 |
2026-08-03 01:01:06 | user=j.mwangi2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-6159 | f
2026-08-03 01:03:17 | user=d.kimani3 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-7308 | f
2026-08-03 01:05:04 | user=a.mohamed | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-7513 | f
2026-08-03 01:05:20 | user=s.mwangi3 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1509 | f
2026-08-03 01:05:38 | user=s.wanjiru | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-8204 | f
2026-08-03 01:10:05 | user=f.wafula2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-9415 | f
2026-08-03 01:11:29 | user=o.gitau2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-2460 | fi
2026-08-03 01:23:25 | user=i.chepkoech | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-6466 |
2026-08-03 01:23:40 | user=g.wanjiru | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-9934 | f
2026-08-03 01:23:52 | user=m.odhiambo2 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-9137 |
2026-08-03 01:26:53 | user=r.njeri3 | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1268 | fi
2026-08-03 01:29:36 | user=m.rotich | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1499 | fi
2026-08-03 01:31:32 | user=h.chepkoech | role=admin | action=UPDATE_PAYROLL_RECORD | employee_id=EMP-1670 |
```

Cover-Up Attempt

2026-08-03 01:38:47 | user=j.mwangi77 | role=admin | action=DELETE_AUDIT_LOG | range=last_2_hours | src_ip=10.20.4.118 | result=DENIED_403_IMMUTABLE_LOG

Incident Response

```
2026-08-03 01:41:48 | user=SYSTEM | action=SECURITY_ALERT | severity=critical | msg="Bulk privilege escalat
2026-08-03 01:41:56 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=j.mwangi77 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | re
2026-08-03 01:41:58 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=svc_backup_admin28 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPO
2026-08-03 01:42:04 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=helpdesk_temp65 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE
2026-08-03 01:42:10 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=n.chebet29 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | re
2026-08-03 01:42:16 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=a.mohamed | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
2026-08-03 01:42:19 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=t.kiprotich | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | r
2026-08-03 01:42:23 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=o.gitau2 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | resu
2026-08-03 01:42:31 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=f.wafula2 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
2026-08-03 01:42:37 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=i.chepkoech | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | r
2026-08-03 01:42:42 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=d.kimani3 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
2026-08-03 01:42:49 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=d.otieno2 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
2026-08-03 01:42:56 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=m.rotich | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | resu
2026-08-03 01:42:59 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=w.akinyi | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | resu
2026-08-03 01:43:02 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=y.wanjiru2 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | re
2026-08-03 01:43:06 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=j.mwangi2 | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
2026-08-03 01:43:12 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=s.wanjiru | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
2026-08-03 01:43:16 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=a.waweru | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | resu
2026-08-03 01:43:19 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=h.chepkoech | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | r
2026-08-03 01:43:25 | user=SYSTEM | action=DISABLE_USER | target=a.onyango | reason=INCIDENT_RESPONSE | res
```